

the possibility that a Social Security overhaul will pump in more billions, the future will bring continued growth for money management companies—a growth that would be very hard to dam up.

All Good Things . . .

How do you know when a theme is played out? Usually it starts to become obvious: prices have gone too high, Wall Street is cranking out new issues to fit the fashion, magazine cover stories are declaring its importance.

Sometimes the clues are more subtle. Little items can be telling. Scholars puzzling over the identity of the author of an anonymous manuscript often find it less useful to examine thoughts, characters, and sentence structure than (as an example of purposeful nitpicking) to simply count the number of times the author wrote “that” rather than “which,” or “shall” instead of “will.” The classic example in my own experience of reading the fine print to discern the end of an investment trend occurred in July 1983, when a four-inch story in the middle of *The Wall Street Journal* caught my eye.

SAN ANTONIO, Texas—Petroleum Acreage Corp. of Texas said it is entering the personal-computer business with a \$6 million project to make and market computers.

The oil and natural gas exploration and production company said it is arranging financing for the project and plans to form an 80%-owned subsidiary, Pact Computers, Inc. The company said the computer it plans to develop will sell for less than \$3,500 and be ready for marketing by the end of 1983. The computer will be able to use software currently available for use on most of the leading personal computers, Petroleum Acreage said.

A company spokesman said that computer operations could become a major part of the company's business within two years if the new computer's sales meet expectations.